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ERIK MARMOR/GETTY IMAGES

Remembering the Victims in Israel

A quiet moment Wednesday at the Nova Festival Victims Memorial near Kibbutz Re'im as Israel marked three years since the attack.

Mamdani Draws Anger With Oct. 7 Post Focused on Palestinians

By LIAM STACK

Mayor Zohran Mamdani ignited intense anger from Jewish groups on Wednesday when he issued a statement marking the third anniversary of the deadly Oct. 7 attacks on Israel that focused largely on the suffering of Palestinians in Gaza.

The mayor posted a 211-word statement on social media that made reference to “the horrific war crimes” committed by Hamas and called the anniversary “profoundly painful for so many New Yorkers.”

However, the bulk of the state-

ment provided a detailed denunciation of Israel’s military actions in Gaza since the attacks, which Mr. Mamdani described as a “devastating, ongoing genocide.” He did not provide a similarly detailed account of the killings of Israelis and abductions of hostages.

“The suffering did not begin nor end that day,” he said, referring to Oct. 7, adding: “That suffering has intensified with every Israeli bomb dropped on ambulances waiting outside hospitals, every drone strike targeting a residential building or journalist, and every shipment of food aid turned away at a border crossing.”

The remarks by Mr. Mamdani,

Talking of Painful Day, but Also of ‘Ongoing Genocide’ in Gaza

who has a fraught relationship with much of New York City’s Jewish leadership, were highly anticipated and closely scrutinized because this is the first anniversary of the attacks on Israel since he took office in January.

And Wednesday’s statement was notably different from those released by other elected officials, including Gov. Kathy Hochul, who

described Oct. 7 as “the deadliest day for the Jewish people since the Holocaust.” In its own statement, the City Council highlighted the story of an Israeli Jew who was hidden from Hamas by a Bedouin Muslim farmer on the day of the attacks.

Some pro-Israel Jewish leaders, and the Israeli government, accused the mayor of minimizing Jewish and Israeli pain on a day of profound grief.

Rabbi Ammiel Hirsch, the president of the New York Board of Rabbis, said Mr. Mamdani’s statement was “morally perverse” and “like sticking a knife into the pain

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Democrats Parrying G.O.P. Jabs on Trans Issues

By TIM BALK

In Ohio, a longtime Democratic congresswoman in a tough race, Marcy Kaptur, is running an ad in which she says she thinks “boys should not play in girls’ sports” and that she is focused on “making your life more affordable.”

In North Carolina, a vulnerable Democratic congressman, Don Davis, has released a commercial that shows him stalking a football field and saying that there are “real concerns about fairness and safety” in youth sports and that

Some Back Sports Ban; Others See Fixation

there “should always be a safe and fair space for women and girls in sports.”

And in several of the country’s most competitive congressional battlegrounds, a leading progressive super PAC is running ads describing Republicans as “obsessed” with transgender people and distracted from rising prices.

As the midterm election approaches, some Democrats in battleground races are moving to respond to Republican attacks casting them as extreme on transgender issues. In some cases, Democrats have reacted by accusing Republicans of being out of touch with voters’ economic concerns, or desperate to change the subject. In others, Democrats have voiced their opposition to transgender female athletes participating in girls’ and women’s sports. At times, their opposition has

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Mother Claims She Didn’t Kill, It Was Vaccine

By LISA MILLER

PAYETTE, Idaho — Andrea Shaw has spent most of the summer alone in a cell in Payette, Idaho, taking comfort from photos of her family, according to her lawyer. Her twins were 18 months old when they died, in May 2025, and her living daughter is three months old. She can talk to her husband, Nate, and the baby only by phone or video chat, which she does several times a day. As she waits for her lawyer to drive up from Boise, she reads inspirational books such as “Tuesdays With Morrie.”

Shaw, 23, is charged with the smothering murder of the twins — Tyson, a boy, and Dallas, a girl — in the middle of the night, in the bed that they shared. At trial, scheduled for January, evidence will show that “the only conceivable explanation” for their deaths is that she suffocated them, the Payette County prosecutor Mike Duke wrote in a court filing. Shaw has pleaded not guilty.

Joe Filicetti, Shaw’s lawyer, describes Shaw as “sweet.” In court, in her red-and-white striped uniform, she mostly comes across as young. The Shaw case, grim as it is, might have been a purely local story except for the extraordinary attention it has received from the captains of the nation’s vaccine-skeptical movement. Three days after their twins died, Andrea and Nate Shaw appeared on a video podcast produced by Children’s Health Defense, the anti-vaccine

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NEWS ANALYSIS

Trump’s Push To War Turns Into a Retreat

Planes Pulled in U.K., And Forces in Gulf

By DAVID E. SANGER and ERIC SCHMITT

To hear President Trump and his aides describe it, the rush to withdraw 12 B-1 bombers from an air base in Britain over the weekend was a prudent precaution, in response to a threat they refused to describe.

It was no big deal, Mr. Trump insisted, and his secretary of state, Marco Rubio, tried to wave it away by noting the Pentagon is “constantly reallocating resources where they need to be.”

But to anyone watching the deployment of American power around the globe in the seven months since Mr. Trump decided to attack Iran, it was another glaring example of how, time after time, Mr. Trump and his defense secretary, Pete Hegseth, have been forced into retreat, pulling back military forces that had been deployed to the Middle East and Britain as a deterrent.

Over the past several months, as the conflict has dragged on, the Iran war has come to reveal enormous new American vulnerabilities, forcing changes that the Pentagon was not contemplating a year ago. But it has also proved a bitter lesson in the unintended consequences that have flowed from Mr. Trump’s war of choice.

Mr. Trump intended the attack on Iran as another demonstration of the American military’s extraordinary power, following the successful bombing raid on three Iranian nuclear sites in June last year and the seizure of President Nicolás Maduro of Venezuela from his bed in Caracas in January.

But rather than enhance American power, the war has constrained it. The closing of bases in the Middle East and limiting the use of one in Britain have, at a minimum, vastly complicated the logistics of projecting power.

American bombers can still reach their targets, of course, but only by flying from the United States, requiring more time and refueling. American carrier groups can still patrol in the Arabian Sea, outside the Persian Gulf, but now they must be resupplied from Diego Garcia, an island in the Indian Ocean 2,200 miles away, requiring additional weeks and huge costs.

But most important, the rapid withdrawals have taught a lesson to the Iranians — and potentially to other adversaries — that they hold the power to chase out a superpower. In Europe, Mr. Trump and Mr. Hegseth are thinking of reducing American

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AT JUSTICE DEPT., DUBIOUS RECRUITS FILL IN THE RANKS

CONSPIRACISTS IN JOBS

Red Flags in Their Pasts May Once Have Been Disqualifying

By GLENN THRUSH

WASHINGTON — A former prosecutor forced off a high-profile murder case for peeking at the defense team’s strategy documents.

A onetime gambling executive who promoted conspiracy theories about the Las Vegas massacre in 2017.

A Florida activist who once served 20 days in jail for hacking a local elections system.

They are among the 130 lawyers who have recently joined the Justice Department’s short-staffed civil rights division as the Trump administration has struggled to fill the depleted ranks of a unit that was once a magnet for legal talent. Since early 2025, upward of 300 nonpolitical career employees, representing decades of experience, have left the division after its leader, Harneet Dhillon, repurposed it to pursue President Trump’s agenda.

As a consequence, the division has opened its doors to recruits, many of them conservatives, some with education and work histories that might have disqualified them from being hired in the past, former officials said. Some have left a trail of hyperpartisan, conspiratorial and, in some instances, bizarre statements, according to an examination of about a dozen recent hires based on court records, social media posts and interviews.

Department officials, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss internal matters, said they have rejected nearly as many applicants as they have hired, 126. Any ideological tilt in the career ranks, they added, reflected the Trump-era applicant pool, which includes conservative activists and recent law school graduates.

Ms. Dhillon praised the quality of the new lawyers, and said she was revamping a division that had been dominated by liberals for far too long.

“For years, the civil rights division recruited from a narrow pipeline of progressive activists and called it excellence,” she said in a statement.

“We are hiring trial lawyers,” she added. “The attorneys The Times singled out have collectively tried hundreds of cases, prosecuted those who prey on trafficked children, won at the Supreme Court and practiced law for decades. That is the experience this division needs to enforce civil

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Adorable Tongues Steer a Billion-Dollar Industry

By JENNY GROSS

AIMARGUES, France — Imagine dozens of cats napping or milling around a space that looks a lot like a pet day care center.

Every day at 4 p.m., dinner is served. The cats step into cubbyholes, each with two trays of kibble atop scales. The cats choose which food they like better, and the scales measure how much they consume. Nutritionists at a Royal Canin pet center in southern France are watching: Which kibble do the animals prefer? How enthusiastically do they chow down? A team uses the data to adjust recipes and devise new ones.

Pet food makers like Royal Canin, owned by the global consumer conglomerate Mars, are pouring money into research to understand the palates of cats and dogs — and to cater to people who see their pets as family members. Even as the war in Iran has



MATHIAS DEPARDON FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Willow, a taste tester for Royal Canin cat food in southern France.

spurred inflation and wage growth has not kept up, the pet food market has kept growing.

And as pandemic pets, adopted in droves in 2020, enter middle age, pet food makers are zeroing

in on aiding aching joints, strengthening tired muscles and protecting cognitive function.

“Aging is one of the biggest opportunities,” said Cécile Coutens,

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FILM PUBLICITY ARCHIVE/UNITED ARCHIVES, VIA GETTY IMAGES

EVA MARIE SAINT, 1924-2026

A beauty with dramatic depth, she brought an intensity to roles and seduced Cary Grant in “North by Northwest.” PAGE B12.

INTERNATIONAL A4-11

Shadow Fleet for Iran’s Oil

Despite Washington’s threat to target them, companies continue to service Iranian tankers near Malaysia. PAGE A7

Why French Students Protest

Pupils at Paul Éluard High School near Paris were fed up with shoddy classrooms and staff shortages. PAGE A6



NATIONAL A12-21

Quest for Vote Fraud Widens

Officials are investigating nonprofits that they say may be recruiting noncitizens for registration, even though noncitizen voting is rare. PAGE A14

More Questions in Tennessee

A judge planned to order the state to preserve any evidence tied to a failed execution attempt of Christa Pike, who has regained consciousness. PAGE A20

Research Networks in Limbo

Scientists are worried about the future of the networks that test vaccines and treatments for H.I.V., tuberculosis and emerging infectious diseases. PAGE A17

THURSDAY STYLES D1-8

Still Lighting Up the Rooms

Lindsey Adelman has used an unconventional management style to build a company that is known for its innovative chandelier designs. PAGE D7

Grounded in Elegance

The home goods company Autumn Sonata makes its bathmats look as artistic as antique tapestries. PAGE D1

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A Return to New York

David Hallberg, the former Ballet Theater star, is bringing the Australian Ballet to perform at City Center. PAGE C1

SPORTS B6-10

Fraternity of Cancer Survivors

A chain of support has developed among M.L.B. pitchers. It all began with a call from Lance Armstrong. PAGE B6

Tearful Farewell to Messi

Argentines were caught up in revelry and emotion at the soccer star’s finale on the international stage. PAGE B10



BUSINESS B1-5

Whistle-Blower Sues I.R.S.

A tax fraud investigator has accused the agency of leaking his personal data to prosecutors in retaliation. PAGE B1

India Dominates Drug Market

Cheap labor and global supply chains are obstacles to bringing generic drug manufacturing back to the U.S. PAGE B1

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Beth Simone Noveck

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